

Project Gutenberg language diversity over time

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Length: 3-4 pages

Abstract

1 Introduction

This study analyses the linguistic diversity in Project Gutenberg's digital library collection over time, specifically examining changes in the proportion of English versus non-English books before and after 2010. The research aims to understand how increased internet penetration in non-English speaking countries may have influenced the linguistic composition of digital preservation efforts.

2 Related Work

Several studies have examined linguistic diversity in digital libraries and Project Gutenberg specifically:

1. Lebert, M. (2008) explored multilingualism on the web and Project Gutenberg's early efforts at linguistic diversification, providing important historical context for understanding the evolution of digital preservation efforts.

2. Gerlach, M., & Font-Clos, F. (2020) analysed a curated Project Gutenberg database, revealing a strong bias toward Western languages, with English comprising 81% of all books. Their work established baseline metrics for understanding linguistic representation in digital libraries.

3 Data

Pre-processing

4 Predicted Results

Discussion

5 Conclusion

References